BRAND & PRODUCT
GUIDELINES

The Equal Lens

Unlearn. Relearn. Grow.

A clearer lens on fairness - now a living product with a face. This edition introduces **Lensy**, our mascot, alongside the canvas, the dual-audience system, and the dark mode.



Version 2.1 June 2026 theequallens.com

Meet the mascot.
Meet the product.

v1 set the foundation - the eQ idea, the two values, voice, colour, type, logo. v2 turned it into an interactive website. **v2.1 gives the brand a face: Lensy.**

Lensy is our mascot new

A curious alien who just landed on Earth and can't stop asking "why?". The face of the brand. → p.03

The site is a canvas

Myths hide in the page; the UN/RE tools erase them and write the truth. → p.11

Two audiences, one brand

A Kids mode and an Adult mode, chosen on arrival and switchable any time. → p.13

A dark theme

Adult mode runs dark. Same brand, flipped surfaces, lightened violet. → p.08

A playful UI kit

Sticker outlines, a doodle set, hand-lettered headlines, tasteful motion. → p.09, 12

Two new accents + tokens

Sun yellow & Sky blue; every colour ships as a named CSS token. → p.07, 15

See through the eQ lens.

Our mark reads as **eQ** - and that double meaning is the whole idea. **eQuality** meets **EQ**, emotional intelligence. One way of seeing the world: fairly, and with empathy. Everything in this book ladders up to it - including Lensy, whose eyes *are* the mark.

VISION

A generation that treats fairness as something they *do* - noticing bias and choosing better, on their own.

MISSION

We help people unlearn bias and relearn empathy through play - before inherited ideas harden into lifelong assumptions.

POSITIONING

For the schools, families, workplaces, and communities raising and shaping each other, The Equal Lens makes bias visible through games and play - because what we absorb early, and repeat unthinkingly, doesn't have to be permanent.

Unlearn & Relearn

Two moves sit at the heart of everything - and the UN & RE characters **are** those moves. They aren't decoration; they're the value system, and on the site they become the tools you pick up (p.11).

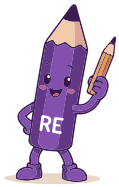


Unlearn

UN · the eraser

Aware · Curious · Brave

Question and let go of inherited bias. Start fresh. On the page, UN erases the myth.



Relearn

RE · the pencil

Empathy · Creative · Hopeful

Rebuild with empathy and imagination. Draw something fairer. On the page, RE writes the truth.

Unlearn → Relearn → Grow → repeat

A continuous loop, not a one-time fix. Awareness, empathy, critical thinking and inclusion all live inside these two.

The cast, simply put: Lensy (p.03) is the face you remember - the curious friend who asks the question. **UN** & **RE** are the two moves you make once a question is asked. One host, two tools.

Meet Lensy.

A curious alien who just landed on Earth and is trying to understand humans. Lensy doesn't teach - the more Lensy looks around, the more confused Lensy gets, and the questions just fall out. "Why is *that* a boys' toy?" The official face of The Equal Lens.



NAME
Lensy

SPECIES
Curious Alien

MISSION
Understand Humans

SPECIAL SKILL
Asking questions that make stereotypes sound strange

FAVOURITE WORD
"Why?"

CURRENT STATUS
Confused, but learning

Lensy is...

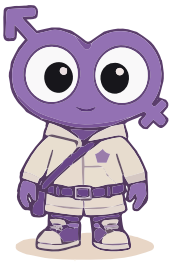
a curious friend · the one asking the question everyone forgot to ask · genuinely puzzled · on your side

Lensy is NOT...

a teacher · a superhero · an activist · the voice of authority · here to say what's right or wrong

When a child sees Lensy, they should feel: *"I want to help this little alien understand Earth."* Personality in three words - **curious, innocent, adorable**.

Built from the mark.



Lensy's face *is* the eQ logo: the ♂/♀ interlock becomes two big, expressive eyes. That's the magic trick - the mascot and the mark are the same shape, so Lensy is instantly, unmistakably ours.



Wave · hello



Stand · neutral



Think · "wait, why?"



Idea · learning

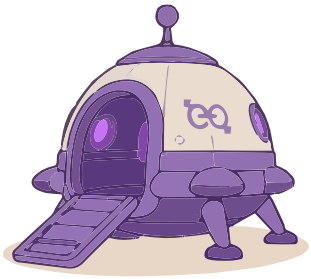
Design rules

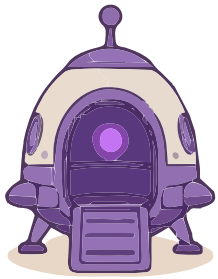
Big expressive eyes (from the mark) · small alien body · neutral - not male, not female · purple palette · childlike proportions · simple shapes that survive as a sticker, an animation, or on a workbook. A visitor, not a human in a costume.

Never let Lensy feel

preachy · activist-like · serious · corporate · like a know-it-all. Lensy is innocent and a little confused - that's the whole charm.

LENSY'S SPACESHIP

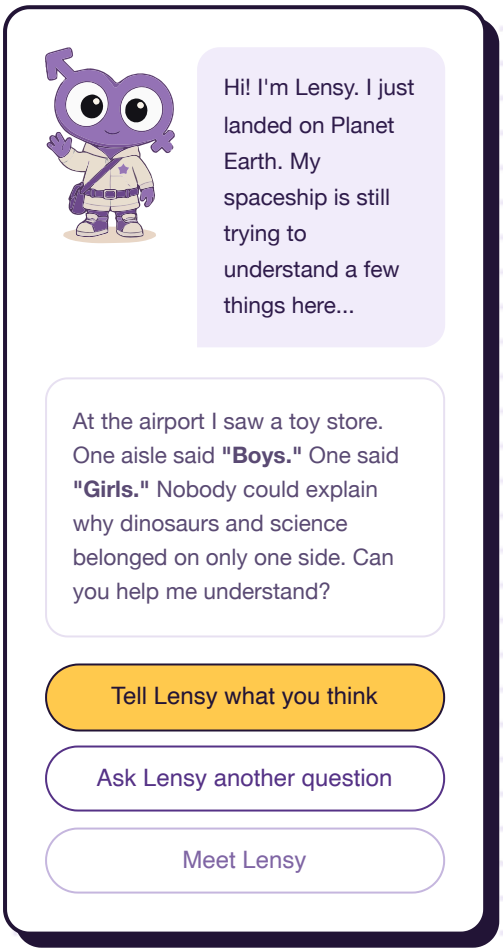




Cute, compact, and purple - built for exploration and asking questions, not battles. Rounded edges, circular windows, a soft glow, a little ramp Lensy walks down, and the **eQ mark on the side** as Lensy's signature. The ship is part of the brand identity, not a prop.

The friend who asks "why?"

Lensy's signature moment on the site. After a few seconds, a little spaceship zooms in and lands, the door opens, and Lensy pops out with a question - playful and never in the way. Curiosity, not a lecture.



The pop-up, roughly

A different question each visit

"Why are some toys called boys' toys and girls' toys?" · "Why do people say some colours belong to boys or girls?" · "Why do people think some jobs belong to only one gender?" · "Why are emotions taught differently?"

Catchphrases

"Wait... why?" · "My spaceship is confused." · "Can you help me understand?" · "That's interesting..." · "I've only been on Earth for three days."

One character, everywhere

Reuse Lensy across website pop-ups, workshops, activity books, classroom games, social posts, stickers, and animations. Same voice every time: the friend who asks the question everyone forgot to ask.

Rules of engagement: appears after ~3-5 seconds · easy to dismiss · never blocks the content · asks, never tells · always leaves the child with the question, not the answer.

Curious. Warm. Brave.

Playful, not preachy

Invite a smile before a lesson.

Curious, not corrective

Ask more than we tell. (Lensy's whole job.)

Warm, for everyone

Challenge the idea, never the person.

Hopeful & active

Learned, so it can be unlearned.

TWO REGISTERS, ONE VOICE

REGISTER	STAYS	SHIFTS TO	A LINE SOUNDS LIKE
Kids	Curious, warm, brave	Short, vivid, encouraging	"Some things feel normal - but are they fair?"
Adult	Curious, warm, brave	Wry, knowing, a little deadpan - still kind	"Bias doesn't retire when you grow up."

Adult copy can be drier and more self-aware, but never cynical, crude, or shaming. **Guardrail:** keep it PG - a kid landing on the adult site should be totally fine.

WRITING STYLE

Do

Sentence case · hyphens, not em dashes · active voice · leave agency ("what would you do?") · vary myths, never repeat a line on a page

Avoid

SHOUTING CAPS · should / must / wrong · "the right answer" · jargon · "biasness" and other site-isms · em dashes in copy

A violet system, four playful accents.

Equal Violet
#553286 · primary / brand



50	100	200	400	600	700	800	900
F3F0F6	E5E0ED	C5B6DE	7F65A4	553286	44288B	331E50	221436

Insight Teal · #2DD4BF
Unlearn accent

Grow Coral · #FF7A5C
Relearn accent

Sun · #FFC94D
Highlight & CTA

Sky · #4FB0E8
Support

Paper · #FBF9FF · page bg

Surface · #FFFFFF · cards

Mist · #E7E0F1 · lines / hover

Violet leads, neutrals carry, accents appear in small doses. **Sun** is our call-to-action yellow (always with Deep Indigo text on it); teal marks "unlearn" moments, coral marks "relearn". Lensy lives entirely in this violet palette.

Same brand, after dark.

Adult mode runs on a dark theme. We don't restyle the brand - we just flip a handful of tokens. Surfaces go deep indigo, text goes light, and Equal Violet *lightens* so it stays legible on dark. The accents (teal, coral, sun, sky) are unchanged.

Paper · #15101F
page bg

Surface · #221A30
cards

Mist · #3A2E4D
lines / hover

Band · #241B38
footer / CTA

Ink · #F1ECFA · text

Brand · #C9B8E6 · lightened violet

Brand-soft · #B3A4D6 · muted violet

RULES OF THE DARK

Sticky notes stay pastel in both themes (with fixed dark text) so the "paper" metaphor survives · the Sun CTA keeps Deep Indigo text · switching themes cross-fades over 320ms · the toggle and the welcome modal are the only ways in or out.

Playful, with purpose.

Baloo 2

Headlines & mascots · 600 / 700 / 800

Wait... why?

Poppins

Wordmark & UI labels · 500 / 600

The Equal Lens · Programs · About

Nunito Sans

Body · 400 / 600 / 700

Some things feel completely normal - but are they actually fair? The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog.

The rule

Baloo 2 carries the playful headline voice across the whole brand - kid and adult, and Lensy's speech (the font-hand token). Poppins handles the wordmark and small UI labels; Nunito Sans does all the reading. All three are free on Google Fonts.

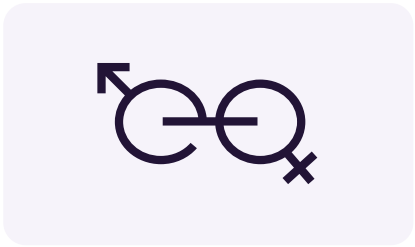
The eQ mark



Primary · violet on light (Kids)



Reversed · white on dark (Adult)



Mono · single colour

Clear space & minimum size



Keep clear space ≥ the height of the mark's opening. Never below 24px / 8mm tall. The browser tab / app icon now uses **Lensy's face** (which is this mark) - see p.03.

Don't



× recolour



× stretch



× rotate



× add effects

Exports live in /brand/logo/; mascot & ship art in /public/ (un, re, Lensy poses, Ship views).

The whole site is a canvas.

Our signature interaction. Bias hides in the page as struck-through "myths" - in doodles, scattered text, and sticky notes. Visitors pick up a tool and act on it. The values aren't explained; they're *played*.

Browse

The default cursor. Read, click, explore. Press Esc to drop any tool.

Unlearn · UN

The eraser. Rub out a myth - the struck text and the sticky note disappear.

Relearn · RE

The pencil. Reveals the truth on a note, or free-draws on the page.

HOW A MYTH IS BUILT

MYTH

~~Boys don't cry.~~

→

TRUTH

Everyone cries. Feelings aren't a gender.

Each myth is structured content (myth · truth · explanation · sources · category · audience) in an OKF-aligned knowledge base. Content drives the interaction - add a myth file and it appears on the page.

Accessibility: the canvas is an enhancement, never a gate. Touch, keyboard, and reduced-motion all get a plain fallback; on small screens myths become tappable cards above the footer.

The playful kit.

Sticker surface

Sticker CTA

Chunky outline (2.5px Ink) + a hard offset shadow (4px 4px, no blur). Cards, buttons, notes - all share this cut-out look. The outline uses the Ink token, so it flips with the theme.

Doodle set



Eight hand-drawn marks - squiggle, sparkle, arrow, heart, star, spiral, zigzag, swirl - in accent colours. Used sparingly as easter-egg texture, never as functional icons.

Motion - lively but tasteful

TOKEN	MOTION	USED ON
anim-float	gentle 9px rise & fall, 5s	doodles, hero art
anim-wobble	±4° rock, 4.5s	stars, badges
anim-bob	bob + tilt, 5.5s	mascots
anim-pop	spring scale-in, 0.5s	notes & Lensy appearing
hover-pop	lift + 1.5° tilt on hover	cards, buttons

Theme changes cross-fade over 320ms. Everything here is disabled under prefers-reduced-motion - motion is seasoning, never load-bearing.

Kids & grown-ups, same lens.

Bias doesn't retire when you grow up. So the site runs in two modes - chosen on arrival with a quirky "How do you identify today?" modal, and switchable any time from the header toggle. The choice is remembered.

Kids mode

light theme · default · Lensy's home turf

Bright, playful, doodle-heavy. Topics: feelings, fairness, who-can-do-what, bodies & consent (age-appropriate), inclusion. The encouraging register.

Adult mode

dark theme

Wry, knowing, dark. Topics: work & money, relationships & home (raising kids, parental leave), single dads adopting, stigma around women ageing or unmarried, body image & media, leadership & confidence.

THE ONE GUARDRAIL

Adult content stays **PG**. It can be candid and dryly funny, but a child who wanders into Adult mode should see nothing harmful - just grown-up situations. Every adult myth is written to that bar.

Mechanically: an audience cookie drives everything - copy, myths, theme, even the logo. No choice yet = the welcome modal; Esc or "decide later" quietly defaults to Kids so we never nag.

How we say it.

ROLE	LINE	USE FOR
Signature	Unlearn. Relearn. Grow.	Lockup, sign-offs, merch
Hook	Bias is learned - so it can be unlearned.	Headlines, ads, pitch openers
Concept	See fairness through the eQ lens.	About page, decks
Adult hook	Bias doesn't retire when you grow up.	Adult-mode hero, campaigns
Lensy	Wait... why?	Lensy moments, kids & social

BOILERPLATE · 25 WORDS

The Equal Lens helps people unlearn bias and relearn empathy through play - turning fairness into something we notice, question, and create, not something we're lectured about.

BOILERPLATE · 100 WORDS

We don't learn bias in lessons - we absorb it from playgrounds, media, family, workplaces, and the words around us. Much of it is set early, and the rest goes unquestioned. The Equal Lens exists to interrupt that. We design playful, purposeful experiences - games, scenarios, a site you can literally draw on, and Lensy, a curious alien who asks the questions we forgot to - that make bias visible and invite reflection, rather than lecturing about fairness. Two moves sit at the heart of everything: unlearn inherited assumptions, and relearn with empathy. Bias is learned - so it can be unlearned.

Let's build a fairer playground.

support@theequallens.com · theequallens.com · @theequallensorg



One source of truth.

Every brand decision ships as a named CSS token, defined once and flipped for the dark theme. Design and build reference the same names, so they can't drift. This is the full map.

TOKEN	LIGHT (KIDS)	DARK (ADULT)	ROLE
--color-brand	#553286	#C9B8E6	Primary violet
--color-brandsoft	#7F65A4	#B3A4D6	Muted violet
--color-paper	#FBF9FF	#15101F	Page background
--color-surface	#FFFFFF	#221A30	Cards / notes
--color-mist	#E7E0F1	#3A2E4D	Lines / hover
--color-ink	#221436	#F1ECFA	Text & outlines
--color-band	#553286	#241B38	Footer / CTA band
--dot	#ECE6F6	#2A2140	Dotted-paper texture
--color-insight	#2DD4BF		Teal · Unlearn
--color-grow	#FF7A5C		Coral · Relearn
--color-sun	#FFC94D		Yellow · highlight / CTA
--color-sky	#4FB0E8		Blue · support
--font-display	Poppins		Wordmark / UI
--font-body	Nunito Sans		Body
--font-hand	Baloo 2		Headlines / mascots / Lensy

Tokens live in src/app/globals.css (dark values under [data-audience="adult"]). Character art in /public/: un.svg, re.svg, Lensy - {Wave,Stand,Think,Idea,Icon}.svg, Ship - {Front,Diagonal}.svg.

Unlearn. Relearn. Grow.

The Equal Lens · Brand & Product Guidelines · v2.1 · June 2026